

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: 1. Realist-idealist spectrum in Indian moral thought

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1. Realist-idealist spectrum in Indian moral thought

[1] Kautilya anchors the realist pole: assume temptation is structural.

|
v

[2] Realist design: rotation, dual custody, audit, positive incentive.

|
v

[3] Gandhi anchors the idealist pole: moral transformation through example.

|
v

[4] Idealist design: trusteeship, self-purification, exemplar-based reform.

|
v

[5] Vivekananda, Basava, Nanak share the idealist register with distinct mechanisms.

|
v

[6] Buddha's Middle Path sits at the synthesising centre.

|
v

[7] Modern governance is Kautilyan in institutional design, Gandhian in aspiration.

|
v

[8] Neither pole alone is sufficient; synthesis is the examiner's expected conclusion.

|
v

VERDICT -> Name both registers and the synthesis point in every Indian-thinkers answer.

ANSWER USE -> Use as the opening framework for any realist-vs-idealist thinker question.

MUST REMEMBER: Indian ethical thought must retain each thinker's own problem, concepts,...

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: 2. Kautilya's anti-corruption control architecture

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2. Kautilya's anti-corruption control architecture

[1] Premise: officials handling public money face structural temptation.

|
v

[2] ARC Annexure-I(2) quotes Kangle 2.9.32: honey-and-poison passage.

|
v

[3] Fish analogy (2.9.33): embezzlement is as unobservable as a fish drinking water.

|
v

[4] Bird analogy (2.9.34): concealed intentions are harder to detect than bird paths.

|
v

[5] Response: rotation, audit, inspection, reassignment of suspect officials.

|
v

[6] Positive incentive: those who increase wealth justly are made permanent.

|
v

[7] Modern analogues: risk-based CDBT audit, dual custody, Lokpal.

|
v

[8] Limit: pure surveillance without service-motivation demoralises honest officers.

|
v

VERDICT -> Kautilya provides the structural premise; pair it with idealist motivation for balance.

ANSWER USE -> Use to build the anti-corruption-design paragraph in any Kautilya question.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: 3. Buddha's Middle Path as a decision-procedure

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3. Buddha's Middle Path as a decision-procedure

[1] Over-reaction pole: excessive, punitive, populist crackdown.

|
v

[2] Under-reaction pole: complacent inaction driven by risk-aversion.

|
v

[3] Middle Path tests: is this response proportionate to the actual risk?

|
v

[4] Eightfold Path: Right Action (lawful conduct) maps to official duty.

|
v

[5] Eightfold Path: Right Livelihood (honest occupation) maps to career ethics.

|
v

[6] Eightfold Path: Right Mindfulness (self-aware judgement) maps to bias-checking.

|
v

[7] Proportionality discipline prevents both populist demolitions and wilful neglect.

|
v

[8] Limit: Middle Path provides the test but not the substantive legal standard.

|
v

VERDICT -> The Middle Path converts 'be balanced' from vague advice into a testable procedure.

ANSWER USE -> Use as the proportionality check in any case-study or vigilance question.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: 4. Gandhi's ethical toolkit: trusteeship, means-ends, Seven Social Sins

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4. Gandhi's ethical toolkit: trusteeship, means-ends, Seven Social Sins

[1] Trusteeship: power and wealth held for society, not as personal property.

|
v

[2] Ends-means unity: impure means corrupt even a good end (strict deontological-virtue hybrid).

|
v

[3] Seven Social Sins (ARC Box 2.8): seven decouplings that destroy ethical governance.

|
v

[4] ARC wording has 'leisure without conscience'; Young India 1925 has 'pleasure without conscience'.

|
v

[5] Gandhi received the list from a correspondent; he published it without claiming authorship.

|
v

[6] Satyagraha: non-violent resistance grounded in truth-force.

|
v

[7] Administrative translation: bureaucrat holds authority in trust for citizens.

|
v

[8] Limit: idealism alone under-designs institutional safeguards.

|
v

VERDICT -> Gandhi provides the aspirational register; always pair with institutional mechanism.

ANSWER USE -> Use to build any Gandhi quotation, trusteeship or means-ends answer.

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5. Vivekananda's Practical Vedanta and Daridra Narayana

[1] Advaita non-dualism: the self in all beings is one.

|
v

[2] Logical consequence: serving the deprived is serving the divine.

|
v

[3] Daridra Narayana: God in the poor, collapsing sacred-secular distinction.

|
v

[4] Selective learning: absorb what is good from others in your own way (2024 Q3a).

|
v

[5] 2025 Q3(c): 'morality of a people' line attributed by UPSC, not in Complete Works.

|
v

[6] Welfare administration elevated from obligation to devotional duty.

|
v

[7] Rejects charity model in favour of dignity model of service.

|
v

[8] Limit: devotional motivation needs institutional accountability to prevent paternalism.

|
v

VERDICT -> Cite Practical Vedanta's logic chain, not just the inspirational conclusion.

ANSWER USE -> Use to build any Vivekananda quotation or service-ethics answer.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: 6. Basava's Kayaka, Dasoha and the Anubhava Mantapa

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6. Basava's Kayaka, Dasoha and the Anubhava Mantapa

[1] Kayakave Kailasa: dignified honest work is itself the divine abode.

|
v

[2] Dasoha: sharing surplus in community service, not personal accumulation.

|
v

[3] Anubhava Mantapa: tradition-attested assembly of sharanas across caste and gender.

|
v

[4] NOT 'world's first parliament': tradition-attested, not securely dated.

|
v

[5] Anticipates Article 17 (abolition of untouchability) and Article 23 (forced labour).

|
v

[6] Proto-egalitarian labour ethic: all honest labour carries equal worth.

|
v

[7] 12th century, Kalachuri kingdom under Bijjala.

|
v

[8] Limit: medieval concepts need disciplined analogy, not identity claims.

|
v

VERDICT -> Present Basava as a historical antecedent to constitutional equality, not its source.

ANSWER USE -> Use to build any Basava, dignity-of-labour or anti-discrimination answer.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: 7. Guru Nanak's three pillars and public-resource ethics

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7. Guru Nanak's three pillars and public-resource ethics

[1] Naam Japna: remembrance of the divine name, grounding ethical conduct spiritually.

|
v

[2] Kirat Karo: earn through honest labour, opposing rent-seeking and corruption.

|
v

[3] Vand Chhako: share with others, supporting equity-oriented resource allocation.

|
v

[4] Public-finance analogy: honest revenue collection + equitable expenditure.

|
v

[5] Scriptural basis firm: Guru Granth Sahib, Angs 8 and 1245.

|
v

[6] 'Three pillars' phrasing is later pedagogical packaging, not Guru Nanak's verbatim triad.

|
v

[7] Classical antecedent of bridging social capital through inter-community sharing.

|
v

[8] Limit: normative ideal, not a self-enforcing mechanism; needs institutional accountability.

|
v

VERDICT -> Use the content accurately but flag the pedagogical packaging of the 'three pillars' label.

ANSWER USE -> Use to build any Guru Nanak or public-resource ethics answer.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: 8. Mahavir's five Mahavratas and Anekantavada

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8. Mahavir's five Mahavratas and Anekantavada

[1] Five Mahavratas: Ahimsa, Satya, Asteya, Brahmacharya, Aparigraha.

|
v

[2] Parshvanatha had four vows; Mahavir separately enumerated Brahmacharya as the fifth.

|
v

[3] Anekantavada: many-sidedness of truth, no single perspective captures the whole.

|
v

[4] Syadvada: conditional predication, the logical expression of Anekantavada.

|
v

[5] Administrative use: multi-stakeholder consultation before policy decisions.

|
v

[6] Aparigraha: non-possessiveness, cautions against accumulation and nepotism.

|
v

[7] Trap: Anekantavada is NOT 'no view is ever correct' but 'truth is many-sided'.

|
v

[8] Limit: Anekantavada taken too far risks indecision; a cut-off for deliberation is needed.

|
v

VERDICT -> Present Anekantavada as a consultative process principle, not as relativism.

ANSWER USE -> Use to build any Mahavir, Jain ethics or multi-stakeholder answer.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: 9. Ambedkar's constitutional morality, equality and fraternity

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9. Ambedkar's constitutional morality, equality and fraternity

[1] Constitutional morality (4 Nov 1948): paramount reverence for constitutional forms (Grote).

|
v

[2] Includes the right of open speech and unrestrained censure of authorities.

|
v

[3] Equality warning (25 Nov 1949): life of contradictions if social inequality persists.

|
v

[4] Political equality without social equality risks democratic collapse.

|
v

[5] Fraternity: common brotherhood that makes liberty and equality self-sustaining.

|
v

[6] Without fraternity, constitutional values need a policeman to enforce them.

|
v

[7] Institutional safeguards: judicial review, fundamental rights, minority protections.

|
v

[8] Trap: Ambedkar is NOT only a Polity figure; his ethics content is independently examinable.

|
v

VERDICT -> Use the morality-equality-fraternity triad to show Ambedkar's GS-IV relevance.

ANSWER USE -> Use to build any constitutional-morality, equality or affirmative-action answer.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: 10. Social capital: bonding versus bridging

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10. Social capital: bonding versus bridging

[1] Social capital: networks of trust enabling collective action (Putnam).

|
v

[2] Bonding capital: within a close-knit group, strengthens in-group cohesion.

|
v

[3] Bridging capital: across groups, enables inclusive governance and accountability.

|
v

[4] Bonding-only risk: nepotism, gatekeeping, exclusion of outsiders.

|
v

[5] MKSS social audits in Rajasthan: work because bridging capital exists or is built.

|
v

[6] Jan sunwai (public hearing): requires villagers to trust the process and each other.

|
v

[7] Guru Nanak's Vand Chhako and Basava's Dasoha are classical bridging antecedents.

|
v

[8] Limit: social capital strengthens governance only when it is inclusive, not insular.

|
v

VERDICT -> Social capital earns marks only when the bonding-bridging distinction is drawn.

ANSWER USE -> Use to build any social-capital, participatory-governance or social-audit answer.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Dharma is contextually ordered duty and right conduct, not a simple...

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: 11. Eight-thinker comparison matrix

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11. Eight-thinker comparison matrix

[1] Kautilya: structural realism, external controls, anti-corruption design.

|
v

[2] Buddha: Middle Path proportionality, Eightfold Path conduct mapping.

|
v

[3] Gandhi: ends-means unity, trusteeship, Seven Social Sins, Satyagraha.

|
v

[4] Vivekananda: Practical Vedanta, Daridra Narayana, selective learning.

|
v

[5] Basava: Kayaka (dignified labour), Dasoha (sharing), Anubhava Mantapa.

|
v

[6] Guru Nanak: Kirat Karo (honest earning), Vand Chhako (equitable sharing).

|
v

[7] Mahavir: five Mahavratas, Anekantavada, Aparigraha.

|
v

[8] Ambedkar: constitutional morality, equality-fraternity, institutional safeguards.

|
v

VERDICT -> Match the thinker's mechanism to the scenario, not just the thinker's name.

ANSWER USE -> Use as the rapid-recall grid before any thinker-matching or comparison question.

EVIDENCE / AUTHORITY / APPLICATION LIMIT: Distinguish primary or securely attributed...

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: 12. PYQ pattern and answer synthesis

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12. PYQ pattern and answer synthesis

[1] Quotation-type PYQs (Vivekananda, Gandhi, Tirukkural) dominate 2018-2025.

|
v

[2] Teaching-type PYQs (Buddha 2020, Guru Nanak 2023, Mahavir 2025) test mechanism.

|
v

[3] Significance-type PYQs (Gandhi 2018) test present-day administrative relevance.

|
v

[4] Social-capital PYQ (2023 Q6b) tests Putnam bonding/bridging with Indian examples.

|
v

[5] Answer spine: name thinker precisely -> mechanism -> Indian example -> limit -> verdict.

|
v

[6] Attribution cautions: Seven Social Sins wording, Anubhava Mantapa dating, three pillars.

|
v

[7] Always translate the thinker's idea into one specific administrative practice.

|
v

[8] Close with the realist-idealist synthesis to avoid a one-sided treatment.

|
v

VERDICT -> The highest-scoring answer moves from thinker to mechanism to example to limitation.

ANSWER USE -> Use as the revision checklist before any Indian-thinkers PYQ attempt.